

Alpha ex Machina Quick Reference

Your turn

1. **Margin, then refresh:** uncommitted funding sources pay Margin; then committed cards become available.
2. **Settle:** pay interest; collect office income and Yield (Surplus or cards; choose for Patent Portfolio); pay carrying costs in Surplus or discard the card (the total rounds down); next stage of each developing event.
3. **Draw 1.** A Forecastable card is shown to the table and can't be run this turn.
4. **Operate:** add 1 funding source (no immediate Margin); 1 staffing move (hire, play CEO, or open an office); buy tools; play investments, treaties, covers; run scenarios; use abilities.
5. **Close:** margin call (keep 1 Margin Credit per 10 Surplus); discard to 8; others may run 1 Breaking scenario each.

The first-player marker passes left every round. Opening hand: CEO plus 6 cards. Redraw the 6 once; keep the CEO.

Money

- **Leverage:** commit a funding source for 1; committed cards are available again next turn (on paper, slide them forward); unspent Leverage is lost.
- **Surplus:** your capital. 0 or less $\Rightarrow$ insolvent.
- **Alternate payment:** only when a card says so. Pay the full adjusted Leverage cost in Surplus, one for one; keep 1. Normal timing still applies. Cameron commits to allow this for one card.
- **Margin:** uncommitted funding sources pay at turn start, before refreshing. Carrying-cost sources have zero Margin. Auto-commit spends lowest Margin first.
- **Hire:** pay Surplus. **Poach** (only cards that say so): Hire cost + 2 Surplus; not a staffing move; the poached employee gains Non-compete and arrives committed (gardening leave).
- **Price:** pay Surplus to buy a tool. Not a talent move; one of each; never poached or fired. Its exposures count like a funding source's.
- **Liquidate** any time: Sale value as Leverage or Surplus. Meme Stock waits until your next turn, even for forced sales.
- **Fire Sale:** after a sale by a company under 10 Surplus, everyone under 15 sells that investment for half its Sale value, rounded down.
- **Long vol:** when a Volatility scenario hits you, each VIX Calls or Long Straddle gains 10% of the table's loss.

Running a scenario

1. Pay Leverage; choose the target if needed. **Focus:** pay 2 more, pick one opponent, it loses double.
2. **Draw 1**, or 2 if its printed cost is 4 or more, even if it is stopped.
3. **Response window:** left of you first, you last. Responses, committed talent, offices, or tools, liquidation. No responses to responses.
4. **Stop:** cancel the scenario. Pay extra Leverage to push through only if the Stop names a price. Acts of God can't be stopped.
5. **Resolve**, then check insolvency.

A free Bank Run (Emergency Equity Infusion) is run in full at once, never Focused; then the scenario it interrupted picks up again. Everything Is Securities Fraud: when the scenario ends, its target loses what scenarios have cost it this round, again.

Financials (banks and funds)

- **Retail Deposits:** Short-Term Rates exposure, except a third of them (rounded down), which have none; a bank run takes half, rounded down, counting Venture Deposits and Evergreen Credit with them.
- **Investor Capital:** Short-Term Equity exposure.
- **Private Credit:** no exposure; carrying cost $1\frac{1}{2}$.
- **Margin Credit:** no exposure; carrying cost 1; margin call at the end of your turn.
- **Loans** (Credit Cards, Mortgage Lending, Prime Brokerage) are investments with a Credit exposure.

Headquarters and offices

HQ starts free on your board, outside the 40 cards, and stays. Pay **Open** in Surplus for a branch; it shares your staffing move. One of each city per company. No Leverage or carrying costs; never poached or fired. Close a branch with no refund; never your HQ. **Fully Remote:** HQ only, no other offices. Offices with funding income pay 1 Surplus per 3 matching sources at turn start, rounded down; committed sources count. **Chicago** instead counts your three futures treaties together, excluding NFTs. Opening an office does not refresh purchase discounts. Commit prevention is a total across matching clauses.

Drawing and discarding

Extra draws come from scenarios you run, funding sources you add, Responses you play, and investments or employees at the start of your turn. When a card makes you discard, you choose which cards, face up. An empty deck just stops drawing.

Uncommit: make a different card you control available again. Executive Assistant and Delegation Dashboard each do this once between the starts of your turns. Readyng or replaying them does not restore a spent use.

Who gets hit

Each opponent (not you; with Focus, one of them for double) · **Target opponent** · **Systematic** (you too). While any living company controls **Tail Dependence**, all scenarios are Systematic and cannot Focus.

Loss math

Clause amount $\times$ (exposures – hedges, min 0). **x2** counts twice. Nat Cat: Any matches every Nat Cat peril. Fixed exposures (Onion Farms) always count in full. Focused: double each clause.

Protection order: failed programs (“Destroyed if”) $\rightarrow$ covers, ignores, flips $\rightarrow$ halving $\rightarrow$ flat reductions $\rightarrow$ swap payments $\rightarrow$ responses, talent, offices, and tools $\rightarrow$ XoL cap $\rightarrow$ recoveries.

Insolvency

Auto-sell liquid investments. Still at 0 or less: out. Too Big to Fail makes a failure cost everyone else 5 Surplus. If its fallout makes every remaining company fail after automatic sales, its controller wins. Qualifying controllers in the same final wave share the win.

Decks and table size

Deck limits: 3 copies of a card; 1 of a **Signature** card; any number of a **Staple** card. **AI:** AI Bubble Bursts destroys it.

Players	2	3	4
Starting Surplus	14	22	30

Game ends after round 10: most Surplus wins.

Keywords

Forecastable shown when drawn or searched for, not runnable that turn. **Act of God** can't be stopped. **Breaking** runnable at the end of another player's turn. **Developing Event** stage 1 now, one more each turn; turn the card a quarter turn per stage. **Systematic** hits you too. **Focus** pay 2 more to hit one opponent for double; other effects once. **Illiquid** can't be sold. **Non-compete** can't be poached. **CEO** starts in hand; play for its Hire number in Leverage, using a staffing move. Never poached. If fired, return it to hand; pay again to replay. Normal discards apply. **Dark** scenarios may charge separately per Dark card on your board and in your discard pile. Hand and deck do not count. The Paper Shredder removes discard evidence.